

This writer still remembers using EasyCall to page friends and tell them where to meet up, or if venues had changed. Back then, you called an operator, gave them your short message and a landline telephone number (if you were near one), and either waited for the call back, or hoped the message got through to your buddy. Simple co-ordination between groups of people on the move was an undertaking of mammoth proportions. Today, a WhatsApp group chat does the same thing, but with so much less pain and time, and you always have the option of (ugh) calling, or even conferencing everyone in – instant connectivity.

Although the 1990s was when India awoke to the pager, and became one of the fastest growing markets in the history of paging, the US had already had paging services for decades. It was towards the end of this paging era that Research in Motion was founded, and went on to bring smart OSes to pagers first, and then phones later.

Beginnings

In April 1995, Motorola released the first two-way pager called Tango Two-Way Personal Messaging Pager. The Tango was able to receive text messages and email as well, and was able to reply with canned responses, such as



The Motorola Tango